

IN THE WOMB OF THE GARDEN - MOTHER NATURE AND HER DAUGHTERS



AUTUMN'S LAST BREATH & WINTERS SOFT EMBRACE

RECARNATION





RECARNATION



Creator's thoughts

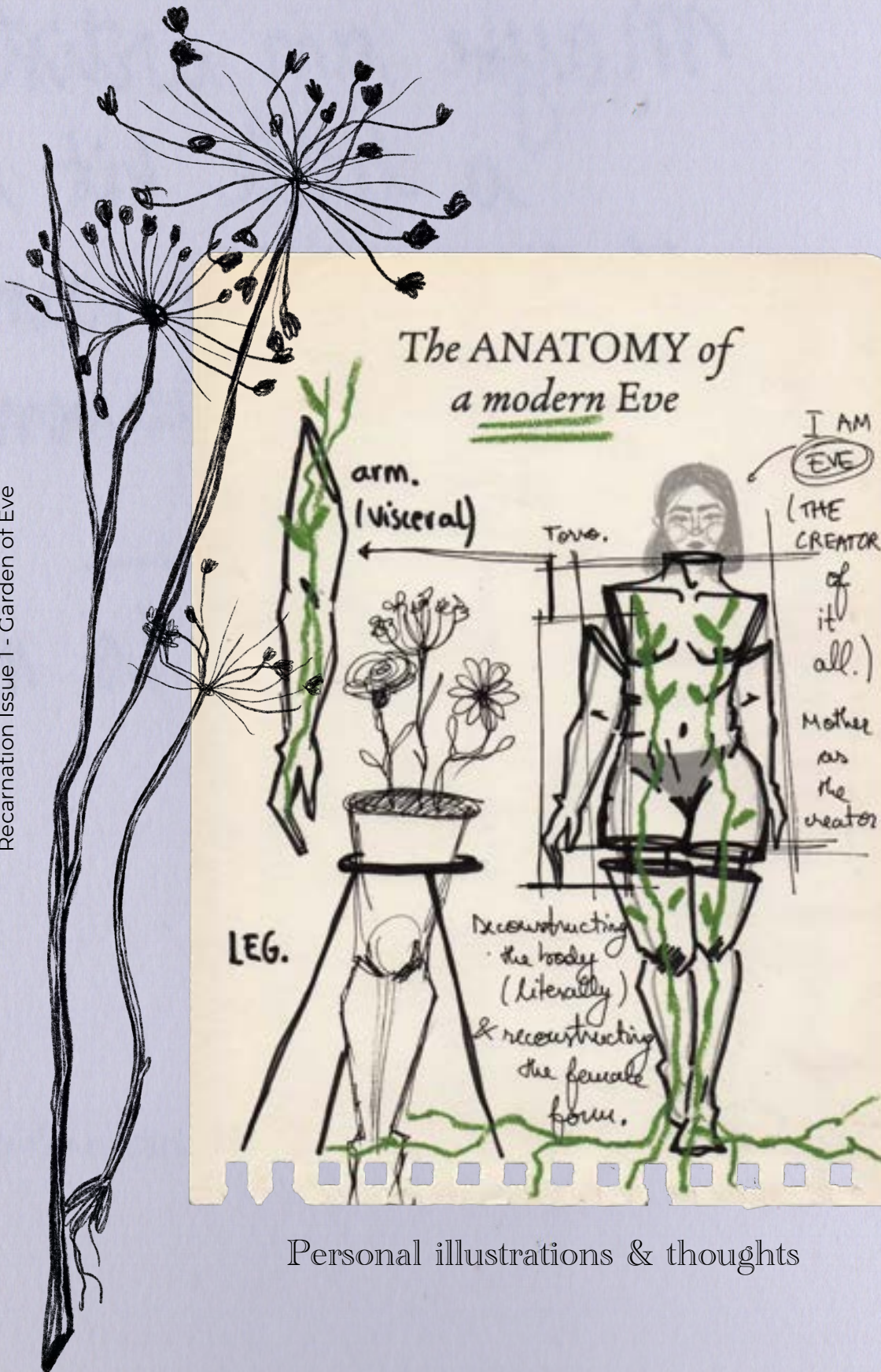


Garden of Eve and the concept for *Recarnation* as a brand are my first ever big projects, so they do feel like they are my first-born children, like a labour of love, like something I need to cherish, protect, but also something that I need to keep growing. When I started designing, I was doing it with Florence and The Machine lyrics in my head, one song in particular playing on repeat: *South London Forever*, which goes like: "We're just children wanting children of our own/ I want a space to watch things grow" (I tend to have a playlist in my head for anything I do in general) Few things can be more suitable to describe my project than this verse. To me, *Garden of Eve* is not a fashion collection, and, in a way, it has never been about fashion. It's been a mission of mine - one about authenticity, about taking responsibility for my actions, about being very intentional with my consumption of materials and resources in general. But besides all logistic aspects, *Garden of Eve* is a space - a space to watch things grow. One year ago, it used to be a space in my head, and now, although still fictional, it lives outside my imagination, materialised into garments. Garments which, first and foremost, should be a safe space for all women dressign their bodies in them. *Garden of Eve* is about embrace, about nurturing yourself, but also nurturing Mother Nature and everything she keeps on giving us, besides our unpardonable behaviour. Thus, it's also an invitation for anyone stepping in to slow down, to become more responsible and aware, to be less vanitous and hungry for consumption, and instead of following trends, to follow the true version of themselves.

While the reference in the name is, as you may have assumed, undoubtedly biblical, *Eve* is not only the symbol of the first woman of my design universe, mother of all-living things, but has lexical symbolic meaning as well. *Eve* is a beautiful word, or better said *moment*, "*immediately before an event or occasion*". These may be ambitious words, but I wish *Garden of Eve* can be followed by change. I wish that my collection is just the *Eve of what's to come*, because it feels like just the beginning. I hope this is the *Eve of change*, the *Eve of something beautiful that is yet to bloom into a more complex artistic expression*. This zine is an intimate collection of women who stepped into my universe. It is, also, hopefully, the *eve of what's to come*. Thank you for stepping in,

Aua Stolars





Personal illustrations & thoughts

from you the flowers grow



i wish i
could remove
everything that
is visceral.

none of
the flesh
that we have
on our
body
has a
meaning

The source
of all of
my insecurities
is
Growth.

But you've
just said it -
growth is a
beautiful thing.





Dressing & Undressing Eve - The Two Graces -

A photography project shot through the nurturing female gaze

The concept was simple - I wanted my clothes to bring joy. I wanted them to be worn by people I care about, who would feel that the clothes care for them. I wanted them to step into the Garden together with them, show them what my collection is like after months of almost living in confinement and working relentlessly. "Dressing and undressing Eve" became the quiet ritual of this series. A gesture of offering and receiving, of placing the garment on the body and watching it respond - stretching, folding, reshaping itself around different lives. Each of them wore the same pieces differently, yet the

garments proved to be embraced with equal tenderness.

In this intimate passing of clothes between our hands, I understood something essential about the collection: it was never only about clothing. It was about reciprocity, evolution, kindness, and slowly undressing our vulnerabilities in front of each other.

Photography, set & art direction
by Ana Stoleru

Digital photography: Canon 200D

Analogue photography:

Canon Prima mini II on Kodak Gold 200

Fujifilm Instax Square & Yashica FR 1 on

Fujifilm Superia X-tra 400



Grace number 1: Andreea

Shot on fujifilm Instax SQ on 25/11/2025



Grace number 2: Teo

Shot on fujifilm Instax SQ on 29/11/2025





Pressed cornflower, previously used in impression prints

Pressed, painted, taped & scanned (above)

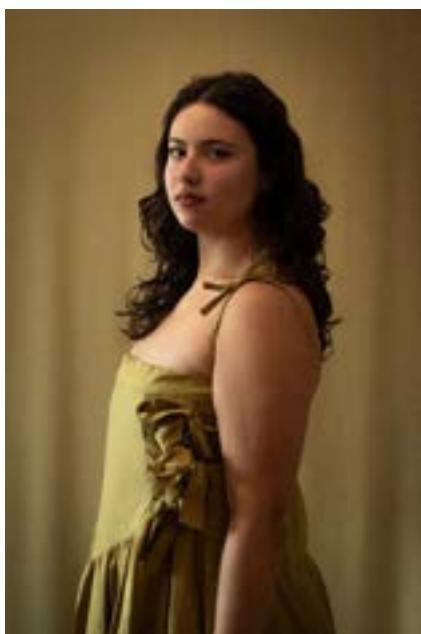
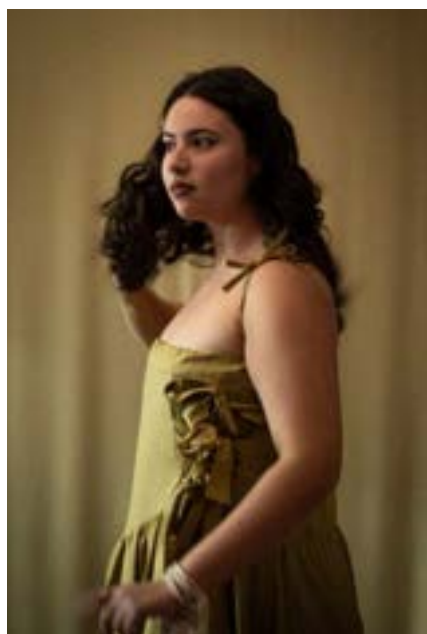
The portrait series - Andreea (right page)





Behind the scenes with Andreea - shot on Kodak Gold 200 film with Canon Prima Mini II



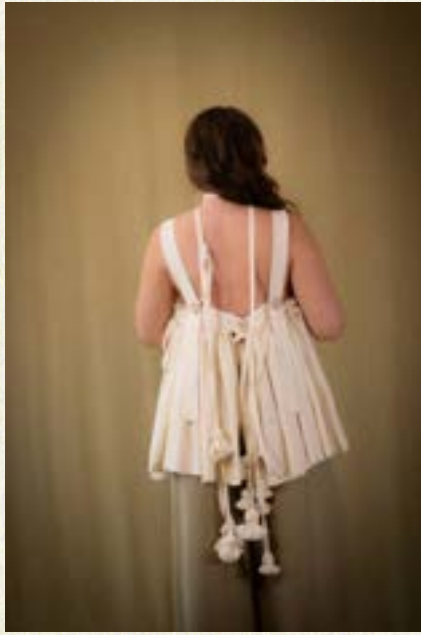




The portrait series - Andreea (spread)

Andreea wearing the "Full Bloom" purple mohair cardigan, realised with COFIL yarn
Styled with lilac zero-waste circle pants











The portrait series - Teo

Teo wearing the adjustable butter white top. Adjustable length straps, adjustable sides through gathering, open back. Handmade clay buttons as closures. Styled with light green adjustable waist pants. Both fabrics provided by Botto Giuseppe.





The soft laws of the garden
- Daughters of the living Earth -



The reflections of Eve



The reflections of Eve



The portrait series - Andreea as the gardener

Crochet doily top - made from a vintage tablecloth, bound with wool tape at the top, with loops for adjustable straps & open back.
Adjustable pants with waist ties and gathered sides draped into pockets, realised with fabric provided by Botto Giuseppe



The CORPOREAL CYCLE of life

from the vessel in which we find ourselves at birth



to a regimen for the body's mortality through its

The fruit was never an apple.

Thoughts on the Divine

The Corporeal cycle of life & the sinful apple



The portrait series - Undressing Teo

Crochet doily top - made from a vintage tablecloth, bound with wool tape at the top, with loops for adjustable straps & open back

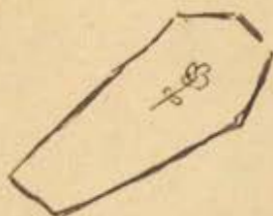


The soft laws of the garden
- Daughters of the living Earth -

Teo wearing the adjustable butter white top
Adjustable length straps, adjustable sides through
gathering, open back. Handmade clay buttons as
closures. Realised with fabric provided by
Botto Giuseppe

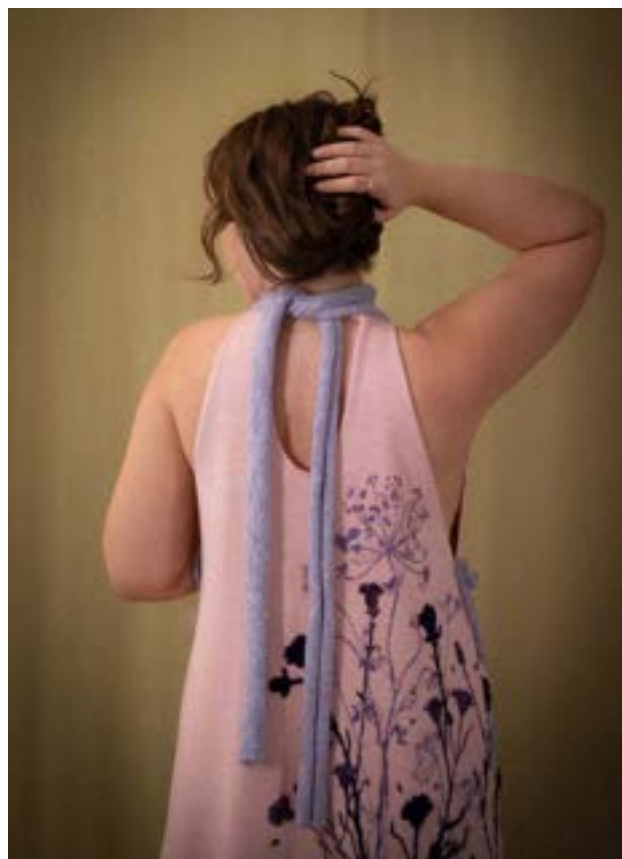


MY
BEST
DRESS



BUT AS WE'RE
~~DANCE~~ DANCING
CHEEK TO CHEEK
AND THE LIGHTS
ARE LAYING LOW
I'LL REQUEST
THIS SONG FOR YOU
LAYING IN THE
GROUND BELOW
BUT ONCE THE SONG
IS OVER
AND ITS TIME TO GO
TO BED, I'LL LEAVE HIM
ON THE DANCE FLOOR
AND RETURN TO
YOU INSTEAD

Florence Welch
Poem from "Useless Magic" - "My best dress"



Impression prints & embroidery
Merino wool knitted dress

The Gardener
- Or the one who tends and nurtures Her -





Carnations scarf
realised with Botto Giuseppe
fabric (plain weave 100% WO)

Handmade crochet beanie

Green Lace slip with adjustable
straps to turn into dress or skirt

Wrap-around adjustable pants
& Gardener's apron both realised
with Botto Giuseppe naturally
elastic wool twill 100% WO





Teo wearing the gardener look
Green lace slip, adjustable twill pants, gardener's apron, carnation scarf and crochet beanie







Teo wearing the “Second cycle of life” Avalon jacket
Jacket made of scraps from the design process, off cuts & washable non woven mesh.
Lined with light cotton, reversible



Dressing & Undressing Eve - The Two Graces -







Andreea wearing the intimate set

Medium length wool bloomers with adjustable waist & thigh measurement, hand sewn carnation details. Made of Botto Giuseppe plain weave wool. Filet crochet top with "The Heart of Eve" detail & hand embroidered appliques - muselin off cuts from prototypes, beads & wool Adjustable strap length & open sides with lace-up detail. Cotton muselin ribbons





The soft laws of the garden - Daughters of the living Earth -

Hand-knitted mood dress, made of brushed mohair, covered in mohair purple flowers made of Yarn provided by COFIL. Raglan construction, knitted from top to bottom, with machine-knitted rib cuffs and collar & bubble hem (elastic thread in the cast off edge). Made of various mohair yarns, including the yarns provided by COFIL.







The soft laws of the garden
- Daughters of the living Earth -

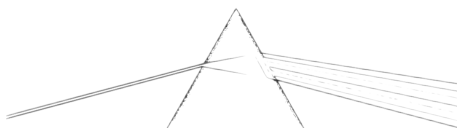
Hand-knitted mood dress, made of brushed mohair, covered in mohair purple flowers. Raglan construction, knitted from top to bottom, with machine-knitted rib cuffs and collar & bubble hem (elastic thread in the cast off edge)





Dressing & Undressing Eve - The Two Graces -

The soft laws of the garden - Daughters of the living Earth -
 Teo wearing zero waste lilac trench with zero waste construction & doing pirouettes.
 Brushed mohair scarf made of COFIL yarns.



Symphony of lights - Through the optical prism -

The instrument for this experiment was small and deceptively ordinary: a handheld optical prism. A prism is both a tool and a trickster. It fractures the world, breaking reality into unexpected pieces. What fascinated me was not only the visual distortion but the emotional one as well - how a familiar moment could feel suddenly enchanted, how a face could be softened, how a beam of light could spill into the frame like visible magic. By holding the prism close to the lens and letting instinct guide the angle, I learned to surrender control and enter a state of flow. Backgrounds melt into soft rainbows.

Edges bloom with spectral halos. Every shot becomes a small experiment in perception, a reminder that reality is never fixed but always flickering.

What I love most is the sense of motion this technique creates. Even in stillness, the frame vibrates with the energy of a light beam searching for a surface. The prism becomes a collaborator, not a filter: unpredictable, mercurial, alive.

Symphony of Lights is an invitation to see the world through a dreamy filter and witness the light behave like music: bending freely, spilling generously, and revealing colour where we least expect it.





The soft laws of the garden - Daughters of the living Earth -
Andreea wearing the cornflower hand knitted cardigan and purple mohair knitted skirt.
Purple skirt and flowers made of Cofil yarn.







The soft laws of the garden
- Daughters of the living Earth -

Andreea wearing the second cycle of life quilted jacket - stuffed with recycled wool scraps (from off cuts, unused samples, abandoned garments) hand-brushed fill. Free motion quilt.







The soft laws of the garden - Daughters of the living Earth -
Andreea wearing the merino wool jacquard sweater with hand embroidered flowers. Styled with
silk georgette adjustable waist skirt - zero waste construction, hand sewn carnation appliques.



Dressing & Undressing Eve - The Two Graces -





Dressing & Undressing Eve - The Two Graces -





Epilogue

I would like to kindly thank my sponsors, who have contributed greatly to the process of bringing Garden of Eve to life.



Botto Giuseppe

Thank you for the amazing, sustainable wool fabrics.



Thank you for the softest, dreamiest yarns.

A person with long brown hair, wearing a purple long-sleeved shirt, is seen from behind, looking out over a field of green plants. The background features a line of bare trees under a cloudy sky. The text "Autumn's last breath & Winter's soft embrace" is overlaid in the center.

Autumn's last breath
& Winter's soft embrace



The soft laws of the garden
- What We Grew Together -

Spontaneous photoshoot with my cousin Riana,
between rain drops, frozen branches, muddy fields,
but enchanted by the fog and the unexpectedly green,
autumnal sprouting fields



Autumn's last breath, winter's soft embrace













Autumn's last breath, winter's soft embrace









Riana holding “The Heart of Eve” printed silk scarf
in all three colour families



Autumn's last breath, winter's soft embrace





In the Womb of the Garden
Mother Nature and her Daughters

A photoshoot realised in my grandmother's garden, with her daughter, by her daughter's daughter



Portraits of three generations, the seasons of life and what they bring

The garden itself played the leading role - in a rainy afternoon, late November - nature had let go of its softness and revealed its bones - tangled branches, wet soil, the last stubborn leaves clinging to brittle stems.

The concept was to let the Garden become a sort of living womb, holding us together in its soft, overgrown embrace. My mother and grandmother became reflections of one another, echoing movements,

postures. And there I was, documenting our bloodline. Their silhouettes aligned like two halves of the same archetype.

I didn't ask them to pose. I didn't want to bend them into shapes or direct their expressions. Instead, I let them inhabit the space as they always had: naturally, instinctively, guided by habit rather than instruction.

In letting the Garden lead, they simply were - effortless, unposed, and wholly themselves.





Portrait of my grandmother







My mother and my grandmother, wearing Merino wool jacquard sweater and lilac circle trousers and brushed mohair scarf. Impression print merino wool vest, with adjustable width and flared shape. All ribbing realised with COFIL yarn. Styled with green bubble skirt. Arm warmers in irregular rib and green bandana.



Walking through my grandparents' garden, still bright and fresh during the last days of autumn - breathing in the smell of dirt & taking in the cold rain















My mother & my mother's mother,
hiding from the rain in between shots







On set: Behind the scenes of Recarnation on 35 mm film

My mixed media practice

The decision to photograph the collection myself did not come from a place of over-estimating myself, or arrogance, but rather from a place of being in full control of the journey that "Garden of Eve" was (which was a rather intimate one for everyone involved) My photography is by no means perfect, or even "good" from a technical point of view - but it is, above all, representative of my practice. "More is more", maximalist, busy, visually complex, textured,

grainy. I've always preferred analogue techniques, which is why I chose to work with film photography and polaroids (which I've later scanned and pasted in this book - shadows, dust and light-leaks included, nothing edited or cosmeticised.)

This is an ode to mixed media, to abundance and to creative exploration.



Canon Prima mini II on Kodak gold (above). Yashika FR 1 on FujiFilm Superia X-tra 400 (below)







Yashika FR 1 on FujiFilm Superia X-tra 400 (spread)



Behind the scenes on 35 mm film - Andreea. Canon Prima mini II on Kodak gold.







Behind the scenes on 35 mm film

Canon point&shoot camera & Kodak Gold film (above & left page)



Yashika FR 1 on FujiFilm Superia X-tra 400 (spread)



Behind the scenes on 35 mm film

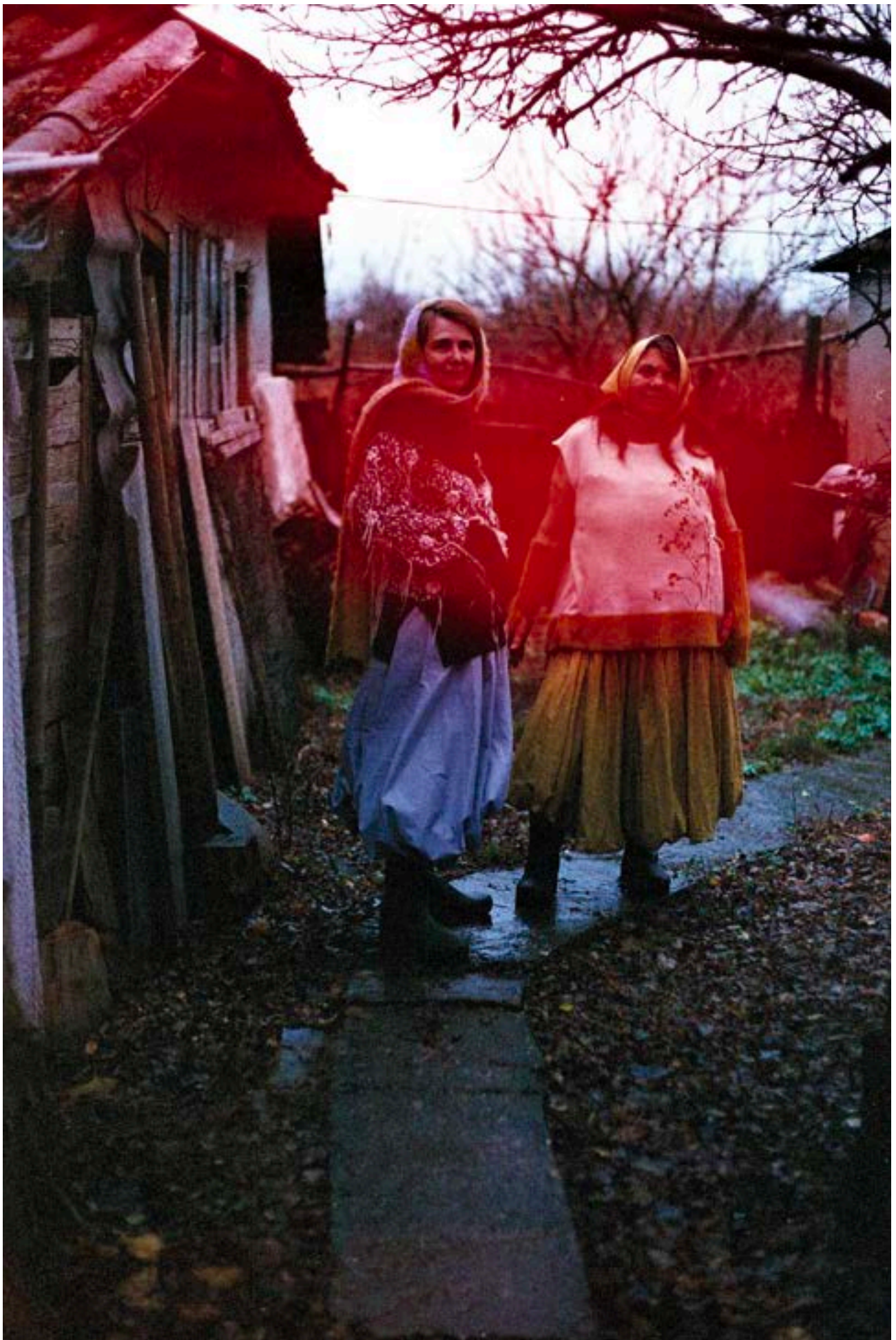




Behind the scenes on 35 mm film

Yashika FR 1 on FujiFilm Superia X-tra 400







Behind the scenes on 35 mm film

Yashika FR 1 on FujiFilm Superia X-tra 400 (spread)





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Sitography:

blumenhaus-magazine.com

Disclaimer

The design of the lookbook highly references the design of Blumenhaus magazine, as stated in the bibliography and sitography.

Various numbers of the Blumenhaus magazine have been by my side as an amazing source of inspiration since the beginning of designing this collection - and this lookbook is an ode to that.

All the materials have been realised for didactic purposes & will not be published or commercialised. I acknowledge the resemblance and credit the source of inspiration accordingly, and, finally, would like to thank Blumenhaus for providing all of us botany enthusiasts with an incredibly beautiful monthly read.





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